

QRU • HEALTH



TEACHER GUIDE

QRU Factory Acceptance Test — Understanding Sleep and Rest — Teacher Guide

Foundational • General public
A Sleep & Rest learning product

**QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding
Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide**

QRU PRESS™

Edition 1

TREASURE STANDARD(TM) CERTIFIED

QRU Teacher Guide - Health

QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide

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QRU Teacher Guide

QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding Sleep and Rest

Product Type: Teacher Guide

Content Area: Health Education / Life Skills / Wellness

Primary Audience: Classroom teachers, homeschool educators, health educators, youth facilitators, and instructional leaders

Recommended Grade Band: Middle School and High School

Suggested Time: 45-60 minutes

QRU Essential Question:

Why do humans need sleep, and can rest replace it?

Student-Friendly Answer:

Sleep is a biologically essential process that helps the brain, immune system, heart, metabolism, emotions, and body recover. Rest can reduce physical or mental strain, but it cannot fully replace enough high-quality sleep.

QRU Memory Sentence:

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

1. Lesson Overview

Sleep is not "doing nothing." During sleep, the body and brain perform active maintenance that supports learning, memory, emotional regulation, immune function, growth, metabolism, heart health, and physical recovery.

Rest is also valuable. Quiet time, relaxation, meditation, stretching, reading, and reducing stress can help the body recover from effort. However, rest does not replace the biological functions of sleep.

In this lesson, students learn the difference between sleep and rest, examine how sleep affects health and performance, identify habits that support better sleep, and create a realistic one-week sleep-improvement plan.

2. Teacher Safety and Health Guidance

This lesson provides educational information only. It is not medical advice, diagnosis, or

treatment.

Teachers should avoid asking students to publicly share private medical information, trauma history, family circumstances, housing instability, medication use, or mental health concerns.

Encourage students to speak with a trusted adult, parent/guardian, school nurse, counselor, or qualified healthcare professional if they experience:

- Persistent trouble falling asleep or staying asleep
- Loud snoring
- Gasping, choking, or breathing pauses during sleep
- Severe daytime sleepiness
- Falling asleep unintentionally during the day
- Sleep problems that interfere with school, safety, mood, or relationships
- Nightmares or sleep difficulties related to trauma or stress
- Symptoms of anxiety, depression, self-harm thoughts, or other mental health concerns
- Suspected sleep apnea, narcolepsy, restless legs, or another sleep disorder

Use a supportive, non-shaming approach. Some students may have caregiving responsibilities, noisy housing, shared rooms, shift-work households, unstable housing, trauma histories, or medical sleep disorders that make sleep routines difficult.

3. Standards Alignment

This lesson is generally aligned to the National Health Education Standards, Third Edition, SHAPE America, especially the following skill and concept areas. No specific state standard alignment is claimed.

| NHES-Aligned Area | Lesson Connection |

|---|---|

| Standard 1: Use functional health information to support health and well-being | Students learn how sleep supports brain, body, immune, emotional, and physical health. |

| Standard 2: Analyze influences that affect health and well-being | Students examine how screens, caffeine, stress, schedules, light, noise, environment, and responsibilities affect sleep. |

| Standard 3: Access valid and reliable health information, products, and services | Students learn when sleep concerns may require help from a trusted adult or healthcare professional. |

| Standard 5: Use decision-making skills to support health and well-being | Students evaluate realistic choices that improve or interfere with sleep. |

| Standard 6: Use goal-setting skills to support health and well-being | Students create a one-week sleep-improvement plan. |

| Standard 7: Demonstrate health practices and behaviors that support health and well-being |
Students identify sleep hygiene habits and select practical strategies. |

4. Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

1. Explain why sleep is biologically essential for brain function, immune health, heart health, metabolism, emotional regulation, and physical recovery.
 2. Differentiate between sleep and rest using accurate examples.
 3. Identify potential effects of chronic insufficient sleep, including impaired attention, memory, learning, mood, safety, and long-term health.
 4. Describe evidence-informed sleep hygiene habits that support sleep quality.
 5. Apply sleep-supporting strategies by creating a realistic one-week sleep-improvement plan.
 6. Recognize clinical warning signs that may require help from a trusted adult and qualified healthcare professional.
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5. Key Vocabulary

| Term | Student-Friendly Definition |

|---|---|

| Sleep | A natural, biologically essential state when the brain and body perform important repair, regulation, and memory processes. |

| Rest | A period of reduced physical or mental effort. Rest can help you recover, but it does not fully replace sleep. |

| Sleep hygiene | Habits and environment choices that support better sleep quality. |

| Circadian rhythm | The body's internal 24-hour clock that helps regulate sleepiness, alertness, hormones, and body temperature. |

| Sleep deprivation | Not getting enough sleep for the body's needs. |

| Chronic insufficient sleep | Repeatedly getting too little sleep over time. |

| Sleep quality | How well someone sleeps, including how easily they fall asleep, stay asleep, and feel rested afterward. |

| Insomnia | Ongoing trouble falling asleep, staying asleep, or waking too early with daytime problems. |

| Sleep apnea | A sleep-related breathing disorder where breathing may repeatedly pause or become shallow. Loud snoring or gasping can be warning signs. A healthcare professional should evaluate suspected sleep apnea. |

| Caffeine | A stimulant found in coffee, tea, energy drinks, some sodas, chocolate, and some medicines. It can make it harder to fall asleep. |

| Melatonin | A hormone the body naturally makes to help signal sleep timing. Students should not use supplements without guidance from a parent/guardian and healthcare professional. |

6. Age-Appropriate Sleep Recommendations

Recognized public health and sleep medicine organizations, including the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, the American Academy of Sleep Medicine, and the American Academy of Pediatrics, recommend the following general sleep durations:

| Age Group | Recommended Sleep Per 24 Hours |

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| Children ages 6-12 | 9-12 hours |

| Teens ages 13-18 | 8-10 hours |

| Adults ages 18+ | 7 or more hours |

Teacher Note: Middle school classes may include students who fall into either the 6-12 or 13-18 age range. High school students generally fall into the 13-18 age range. Individual needs may vary, and quality of sleep also matters.

7. Materials Needed

- Board, projector, or chart paper
 - Student notebooks or printed handouts
 - Scenario cards or projected scenarios
 - One-week sleep-improvement plan template
 - Quick quiz
 - Exit ticket
 - Rubric for student sleep-improvement plan
 - Optional: sticky notes, highlighters, timer, calm instrumental music for transition
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8. Lesson at a Glance

| Lesson Segment | Time |

---|---:|

Warm-Up: "Is Rest the Same as Sleep?"	5-7 min
Mini-Lesson: What Sleep Does	10-12 min
Guided Practice: Sleep or Rest?	8-10 min
Discussion: Sleep Barriers and Real-Life Choices	8-10 min
Independent Practice: One-Week Sleep Plan	10-15 min
Formative Assessment: Quick Quiz or Exit Ticket	5 min
Closing Reflection	2-3 min

9. Lesson Procedure

A. Warm-Up: "Is Rest the Same as Sleep?"

Time: 5-7 minutes

Teacher Directions

Display or read the following questions:

1. If someone lies on the couch for two hours but does not sleep, did their body get the same benefits as sleep?
2. Why might someone still feel tired after resting?
3. What do you think sleep does that quiet rest cannot fully do?

Students may respond silently in writing, discuss with a partner, or complete a quick poll.

Teacher Talking Points

Use or adapt:

"Today we are exploring a common question: Can rest replace sleep? Rest matters. Relaxing, taking breaks, and reducing stress can help the body and mind. But sleep is different. During sleep, the brain and body complete important biological processes that cannot be fully replaced by simply lying down, watching videos, or being quiet."

Expected Student Ideas

Students may say:

- Sleep helps the body recharge.
- Rest helps but may not be enough.
- Someone might feel tired after resting because they did not actually sleep.
- Screens, stress, caffeine, or noise can make it hard to sleep.

Transition

"Let's look at what sleep actually does inside the body."

B. Mini-Lesson: What Sleep Does

Time: 10-12 minutes

Core Content

Teach the following key ideas.

1. Sleep Supports the Brain

Sleep helps with:

- Attention
- Learning
- Memory consolidation
- Problem-solving
- Reaction time
- Decision-making

Plain-language explanation:

When you sleep, your brain helps organize and store what you learned. Without enough sleep, it can be harder to focus, remember, and make good decisions.

2. Sleep Supports Emotional Regulation

Sleep affects:

- Mood
- Stress response
- Patience
- Impulse control
- Emotional balance

Plain-language explanation:

When people are sleep-deprived, emotions can feel bigger and harder to manage.

3. Sleep Supports the Immune System

Sleep helps the immune system function well. Chronic insufficient sleep may make it harder for the body to respond effectively to illness.

4. Sleep Supports Growth and Physical Recovery

Sleep is important for:

- Muscle recovery
- Tissue repair
- Growth and development
- Athletic performance
- Injury recovery

5. Sleep Supports Heart and Metabolic Health

Over time, chronic insufficient sleep is associated with higher risk for health concerns such as:

- High blood pressure
- Obesity
- Type 2 diabetes
- Cardiovascular disease

6. Sleep Supports Safety

Insufficient sleep can increase risk of:

- Slower reaction time
- Mistakes
- Accidents
- Drowsy driving, for older students

Teacher Script

"Sleep is not wasted time. It is active maintenance. Your brain is processing memories, your body is repairing tissues, your immune system is regulating itself, and your emotions are being reset. Rest can reduce strain, but sleep performs deeper biological work."

Memory Reinforcement

Ask students to repeat or write:

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

C. Guided Practice: Sleep or Rest?

Time: 8-10 minutes

Teacher Directions

Read each scenario. Students decide whether the example is mostly sleep, rest, or neither, and explain why.

Students may answer individually, in pairs, or using hand signals.

Scenario 1

Maya lies in bed with the lights off and falls asleep for eight hours.

Answer: Sleep

Why: Maya is actually sleeping, allowing the brain and body to perform sleep-related repair and regulation.

Scenario 2

Jordan sits quietly on the couch for 30 minutes after soccer practice and listens to calm music.

Answer: Rest

Why: Jordan is reducing physical and mental demand, but this does not fully replace sleep.

Scenario 3

Ari stays up until 2:00 a.m. scrolling on a phone, then says, "I was resting because I was lying down."

Answer: Neither, or low-quality rest

Why: Lying down while using a stimulating screen late at night may not provide true rest and may interfere with sleep.

Scenario 4

Sam takes a short nap after several nights of poor sleep.

Answer: Sleep, but not a complete replacement for consistent nighttime sleep

Why: A nap can help reduce sleepiness, but it may not fully make up for repeated insufficient sleep.

Scenario 5

Talia meditates for 10 minutes before bed.

Answer: Rest that may support sleep

Why: Meditation is not the same as sleep, but it may help the body calm down and prepare for sleep.

Scenario 6

Chris regularly sleeps 5 hours on school nights and tries to "catch up" by sleeping until noon on weekends.

Answer: Sleep, but likely an inconsistent pattern

Why: Extra weekend sleep may help somewhat, but repeated school-night sleep deprivation can still affect health, mood, learning, and daily performance.

D. Discussion: Sleep Barriers and Real-Life Choices

Time: 8-10 minutes

Teacher Guidance

Frame this discussion carefully. Avoid shaming students. Many students do not fully control their sleep environment or schedule.

Say:

"Sleep advice is not always easy to follow. Some people share a room, care for siblings, live in noisy places, have anxiety, work jobs, help family members, or deal with medical conditions. Our goal is not to blame anyone. Our goal is to identify small, realistic changes that may help."

Discussion Questions

Choose 3-5:

1. What is one reason students may not get enough sleep?
2. Which sleep barriers are mostly within a student's control? Which are not?
3. How can screen use affect sleep?
4. Why might caffeine late in the day make sleep harder?
5. What are realistic ways to create a calmer bedtime routine?
6. How might stress or worry affect sleep?
7. Why is it important not to shame people for sleep problems?
8. When should a student ask for help from a trusted adult or healthcare professional?
9. What is one small sleep habit that could help many people?
10. Why can rest help but not fully replace sleep?

Key Ideas to Reinforce

- Sleep needs are biological, not a sign of laziness.
 - Rest is useful, but sleep is essential.
 - Sleep hygiene strategies work best when they are realistic.
 - Some sleep problems require professional support.
 - Students should seek help if sleep problems are persistent or severe.
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10. Sleep Hygiene: Practical Strategies

Introduce sleep hygiene as a set of habits that can improve sleep quality. Make clear that these strategies are helpful but may not solve all sleep problems.

Student-Friendly Sleep Hygiene Strategies

| Strategy | Why It May Help |

|---|---|

| Keep a consistent sleep and wake time when possible | Supports the body's internal clock |

| Get morning light when possible | Helps regulate circadian rhythm |

| Create a calming bedtime routine | Signals the body that sleep is approaching |

| Reduce bright screens before bed when possible | Bright light and stimulating content can delay sleepiness |

| Avoid caffeine late in the day | Caffeine can stay in the body for hours |

| Make the sleep space as dark, cool, and quiet as possible | Supports sleep quality |

| Use the bed mainly for sleep when possible | Helps the brain connect bed with sleeping |

| Exercise regularly, but avoid intense exercise too close to bedtime if it disrupts sleep | Physical activity can support sleep |

| Avoid large heavy meals right before bed if they cause discomfort | Digestion discomfort can interfere with sleep |

| Write down worries or tomorrow's tasks before bed | May reduce racing thoughts |

| Ask for help when sleep problems persist | Some sleep problems need support |

Important Note About Melatonin and Sleep Products

Students should not begin melatonin, supplements, sleep aids, or medication changes without guidance from a parent/guardian and qualified healthcare professional.

11. Independent Practice: One-Week Sleep-Improvement Plan

Time: 10-15 minutes

Teacher Directions

Students create a realistic plan for one week. They may use their real schedule or a fictional student profile if privacy is preferred.

Tell students:

"Your plan should be realistic, respectful of your life circumstances, and focused on small improvements. You do not need to share private information."

One-Week Sleep-Improvement Plan Template

Student Name:

Week of:

Part 1: My Sleep Goal

Choose one:

- ? I want to fall asleep more easily.
- ? I want to wake up feeling more rested.
- ? I want to reduce screen use before bed.
- ? I want to create a calmer bedtime routine.
- ? I want to make my sleep schedule more consistent.
- ? I want to ask for help with a sleep concern.
- ? Other:

My specific goal:

Part 2: My Current Sleep Challenge

Choose one or more:

- ? I go to bed later than planned.
- ? I use screens close to bedtime.
- ? I drink caffeine too late.
- ? My room or home is noisy.
- ? I feel stressed or worried at night.
- ? I have responsibilities that affect sleep.
- ? My schedule changes a lot.
- ? I wake up during the night.
- ? I feel very sleepy during the day.
- ? I am not sure.

- ? Other:

One sentence about my challenge:

Part 3: My One-Week Plan

| Day | Target Bedtime | Target Wake Time | Sleep-Supporting Habit I Will Try | Possible Barrier | Backup Plan |

|---|---|---|---|---|---|

| Monday | | | | |

| Tuesday | | | | |

| Wednesday | | | | |

| Thursday | | | | |

| Friday | | | | |

| Saturday | | | | |

| Sunday | | | | |

Part 4: My Sleep-Supporting Habits

I will try at least two:

- ? Put my phone or device away earlier.
- ? Use night mode or reduce brightness.
- ? Avoid caffeine later in the day.
- ? Create a 10-minute wind-down routine.
- ? Take a warm shower or bath before bed.
- ? Read something calming.
- ? Stretch or breathe slowly.
- ? Write down worries or tomorrow's tasks.
- ? Prepare school materials earlier.
- ? Use earplugs, white noise, or a fan if available and safe.
- ? Talk to a trusted adult about a sleep concern.
- ? Other:

Part 5: My Help Plan

If my sleep problem continues or feels serious, I can talk to:

- ? Parent/guardian
 - ? Teacher
 - ? School nurse
 - ? School counselor
 - ? Coach
 - ? Doctor or healthcare professional
 - ? Another trusted adult:
-

Part 6: Reflection

One change I think is realistic for me:

One thing that might make this hard:

One backup plan I can use:

12. Formative Assessment Options

Use one or more of the following.

Option A: Quick Quiz

Student Name:

Circle or write the best answer.

1. Which statement is most accurate?

- A. Rest and sleep are exactly the same.
 - B. Rest can help, but it cannot fully replace sleep.
 - C. Sleep only matters for athletes.
 - D. If you lie down with a phone, your body gets all the benefits of sleep.
-

2. Name two body systems or functions supported by sleep.

- 1.
- 2.

3. True or False: Chronic insufficient sleep can affect learning, mood, safety, and long-term health.

? True

? False

4. Which habit is most likely to support better sleep?

- A. Drinking an energy drink late at night
- B. Keeping a consistent sleep and wake time when possible
- C. Watching exciting videos in bed until 2:00 a.m.
- D. Doing homework under bright lights in bed every night

5. Name one warning sign that someone should talk to a trusted adult or healthcare professional about sleep.

6. Explain the QRU memory sentence in your own words:

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

Your explanation:

Quick Quiz Answer Key

1. B. Rest can help, but it cannot fully replace sleep.
2. Possible answers: brain, memory, learning, immune system, heart, metabolism, emotions, physical recovery, growth, safety, reaction time.
3. True
4. B. Keeping a consistent sleep and wake time when possible
5. Possible answers: persistent insomnia, loud snoring, breathing pauses, gasping, severe daytime sleepiness, falling asleep unintentionally, sleep problems affecting school or mood, mental health concerns, suspected sleep apnea.
6. Strong answers should explain that rest reduces strain, but sleep performs deeper biological

repair and regulation.

Option B: Exit Ticket

Student Name:

Answer in 1-3 sentences each.

1. What is one important difference between sleep and rest?
 2. What is one sleep habit you could realistically improve or protect?
 3. When should someone ask for help with sleep concerns?
-

Exit Ticket Sample Answer Key

1. Sleep is a biological state that supports brain and body repair; rest reduces effort but does not fully replace sleep.
 2. Examples: reduce screen use before bed, avoid caffeine late, keep a consistent wake time, create a wind-down routine, ask for help.
 3. If problems are persistent or severe, or if there is loud snoring, breathing pauses, severe daytime sleepiness, insomnia, or mental health concerns.
-

13. Rubric: One-Week Sleep-Improvement Plan

| Criteria | 4 - Strong | 3 - Proficient | 2 - Developing | 1 - Beginning |

|---|---|---|---|

| Understanding of Sleep vs. Rest | Clearly explains that rest helps but does not replace sleep. | Shows accurate understanding with minor gaps. | Shows partial understanding; may confuse rest and sleep. | Shows little understanding of the difference. |

| Realistic Goal | Goal is specific, realistic, and connected to sleep quality or duration. | Goal is clear and mostly realistic. | Goal is vague or only somewhat realistic. | Goal is missing or unrealistic. |

| Use of Sleep Hygiene Strategies | Includes two or more appropriate strategies and explains why they may help. | Includes at least two appropriate strategies. | Includes one strategy or strategies

are not clearly connected to sleep. | Strategies are missing or inaccurate. |
Barrier and Backup Plan	Identifies realistic barriers and thoughtful backup plans.	Identifies at least one barrier and backup plan.	Barrier or backup plan is incomplete.	No barrier or backup plan included.
Help-Seeking Awareness	Clearly identifies when and whom to ask for help if sleep problems persist.	Identifies a trusted adult or helper.	Help plan is vague.	No help plan included.
Completion and Effort	Plan is complete, organized, and thoughtful.	Plan is mostly complete.	Plan is partially complete.	Plan is mostly incomplete.

14. Differentiation and Accessibility

For English Learners

- Pre-teach vocabulary with visuals or examples.
- Allow students to use bilingual dictionaries or translated notes.
- Provide sentence frames:
- "Sleep helps the body by ."
- "Rest is different from sleep because ."
- "One sleep habit I can try is ."
- Allow oral responses instead of written responses when appropriate.

For Students with Reading or Writing Challenges

- Read directions aloud.
- Provide a partially completed sleep-plan template.
- Allow bullet points instead of full sentences.
- Offer speech-to-text or typed responses.
- Pair students strategically for discussion.

For Neurodivergent Students

- Preview the lesson structure.
- Allow movement breaks.
- Provide clear, concrete directions.
- Avoid forcing personal disclosure.
- Allow students to create a plan for a fictional student instead of themselves.
- Offer sensory-friendly sleep strategy options such as reducing light, sound, or

overstimulation when possible.

For Students with Trauma, Stress, or Mental Health Concerns

- Avoid requiring students to discuss nightmares, family conflict, unsafe housing, or personal mental health.
- Use hypothetical examples.
- Emphasize that sleep difficulty is not a personal failure.
- Provide help-seeking options.
- Coordinate with school counselors or nurses when appropriate.

For Students with Caregiving Responsibilities or Shift-Work Households

- Avoid assuming every student controls bedtime, noise, meals, or household routines.
- Encourage small, flexible strategies:
- 5-minute wind-down routine
- Consistent wake-up routine
- Preparing school items earlier
- Asking for adult support when possible
- Using calming breathing or quiet rest when sleep timing cannot be controlled

For Students Experiencing Housing Instability or Shared Sleep Spaces

- Avoid advice that assumes a private bedroom.
- Offer adaptable strategies:
- Eye mask if available and safe
- Earplugs or white noise if available and safe
- Keeping a small bedtime routine
- Reducing screen brightness
- Using a consistent calming cue, such as breathing or reading

For Students with Medical Sleep Disorders

- Do not present sleep hygiene as a cure.
- Encourage communication with a parent/guardian and qualified healthcare professional.
- Allow alternative assignments if personal planning is not appropriate.

For Advanced Learners

- Invite research on circadian rhythm, sleep stages, memory consolidation, or public health sleep recommendations.
 - Ask students to design a school sleep-awareness campaign.
 - Have students analyze how school start times may affect adolescent sleep.
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15. Extension Activities

Extension 1: Sleep Myth vs. Fact

Students research and classify statements as myth or fact.

Examples:

- "Teenagers are lazy if they sleep late."
- "Caffeine can affect sleep for hours."
- "Rest and sleep are exactly the same."
- "Sleep affects learning and memory."
- "Loud snoring can sometimes be a warning sign."

Students must support answers with a reliable source.

Extension 2: Design a Sleep-Friendly Routine

Students create a visual routine for a fictional student who has:

- Homework
- Family responsibilities
- Screen habits
- Stress
- A target wake-up time

The routine must include at least three realistic sleep-supporting strategies.

Extension 3: Public Health Poster

Students create a poster, slide, or infographic with the message:

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

Poster must include:

- One fact about sleep
 - One difference between sleep and rest
 - One sleep hygiene strategy
 - One help-seeking reminder
-

Extension 4: Debate or Socratic Seminar

Prompt:

"Should schools do more to protect student sleep?"

Students may discuss:

- School start times
 - Homework load
 - Sports and activities
 - Technology
 - Transportation
 - Family responsibilities
 - Equity and access
-

Extension 5: Sleep and Performance Reflection

Students write a short reflection:

"How might sleep affect learning, sports, creativity, emotional regulation, or safety?"

Students may connect to personal experience or use a fictional example.

16. Teacher Answer Key: Guided Practice Summary

| Scenario | Best Classification | Key Reason |

|---|---|---|

| Maya sleeps eight hours | Sleep | Actual sleep supports biological repair and regulation. |

Jordan listens to calm music after practice	Rest	Reduced effort, but not sleep.
Ari scrolls on a phone while lying down	Neither / low-quality rest	Stimulating screen use may interfere with sleep.
Sam naps after poor sleep	Sleep, partial support	Napping can help but does not fully replace consistent nighttime sleep.
Talia meditates before bed	Rest that supports sleep	Calming activity may help prepare for sleep.
Chris sleeps 5 hours on school nights and catches up on weekends	Sleep but inconsistent	Weekend catch-up may help somewhat, but repeated sleep deprivation can still cause problems.

17. Closing Reflection

Time: 2-3 minutes

Ask students to complete one of the following:

Option 1: One-Sentence Reflection

"One thing I learned about sleep today is ."

Option 2: Memory Sentence Reflection

"Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair" means .

Option 3: Personal or Fictional Action Step

"One realistic sleep-supporting step someone could take this week is ."

Teacher Closing Script

"Sleep is not a luxury or a sign of laziness. It is a biological need. Rest is helpful, but it cannot fully replace sleep. The goal is not perfection. The goal is awareness, small realistic habits, and knowing when to ask for help."

18. Optional Homework

Students complete one of the following:

Choice A: Sleep Plan Reflection

Complete the one-week sleep-improvement plan and write a short reflection on which habits

seem most realistic.

Choice B: Family Conversation

Ask a parent, guardian, or trusted adult:

- What helps you sleep well?
- What makes sleep harder?
- What is one bedtime routine our household could support?

Students should not be required to share private family details.

Choice C: Research Check

Find one reliable source about teen sleep and write:

- One fact
 - One recommended habit
 - One warning sign that requires help
-

19. Teacher Notes for Sensitive Implementation

- Do not grade students on actual sleep duration.
 - Do not require students to track or disclose personal sleep patterns.
 - Do not imply that all students can control their sleep environment.
 - Do not recommend medication, supplements, or medical treatment.
 - Do encourage help-seeking for persistent or concerning symptoms.
 - Do normalize that sleep challenges are common and support is available.
 - Do provide fictional alternatives for all personal reflection tasks.
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20. Short Reference List and Source Notes

The following sources support the lesson's general claims about sleep duration, sleep hygiene, insufficient sleep, health risks, and clinical warning signs.

1. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. "How Much Sleep Do I Need?"

Notes: Provides public health sleep-duration recommendations by age group.

2. American Academy of Sleep Medicine. Consensus recommendations on sleep duration for children and teenagers.

Notes: Recommends 9-12 hours for children ages 6-12 and 8-10 hours for teens ages 13-18 per 24 hours.

3. American Academy of Pediatrics. Guidance on healthy sleep and adolescent sleep needs.

Notes: Supports the importance of sufficient sleep for teen health, development, learning, and safety.

4. National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute. Sleep deprivation and deficiency information.

Notes: Explains how insufficient sleep affects brain function, physical health, safety, and chronic disease risk.

5. Sleep Foundation. Sleep hygiene and sleep health educational resources.

Notes: Provides plain-language explanations of habits that support sleep quality.

6. Mayo Clinic / Cleveland Clinic patient education resources. Sleep apnea, insomnia, and warning signs.

Notes: Describe symptoms such as loud snoring, breathing pauses, gasping, persistent insomnia, and excessive daytime sleepiness as reasons to seek professional evaluation.

21. QRU Lesson Integrity Check

Before teaching, confirm:

- ? The lesson clearly distinguishes sleep from rest.
- ? The lesson avoids shame and respects diverse living situations.
- ? Sleep recommendations are age-appropriate and source-based.
- ? Students learn practical strategies and help-seeking signs.
- ? Students are not asked to disclose private medical or family information.
- ? The closing reinforces the QRU memory sentence:

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

Continue your understanding at QRU:

